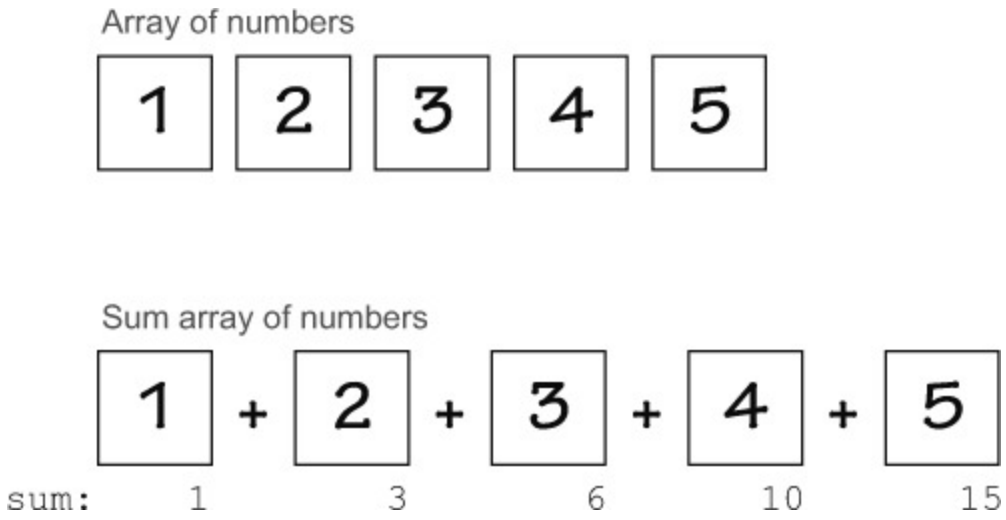
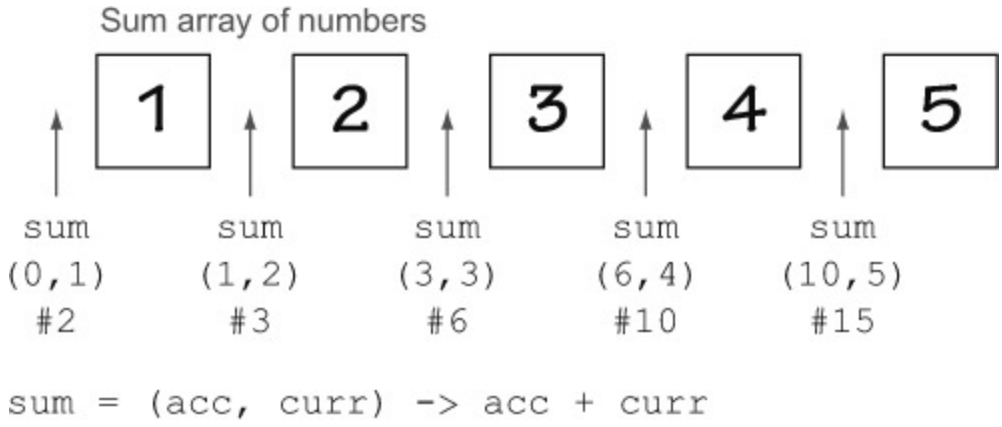
Suppose you want to manually add the numbers from 1 through 5. Insert an addition operator between the numbers, as in figure 3.4.

Figure 3.4. Summing numbers with operator



When you use the `accumulate` function, you're doing the same thing, except that instead of an operator you insert a *function* between the numbers, as in figure 3.5.

Figure 3.5. Summing numbers by folding in a function



You might visualize it as folding the function into the array. In some programming languages it's actually called *fold*, and when the function is inserted to the left (as in figure 3.5), it's called *fold left* or *foldl*.